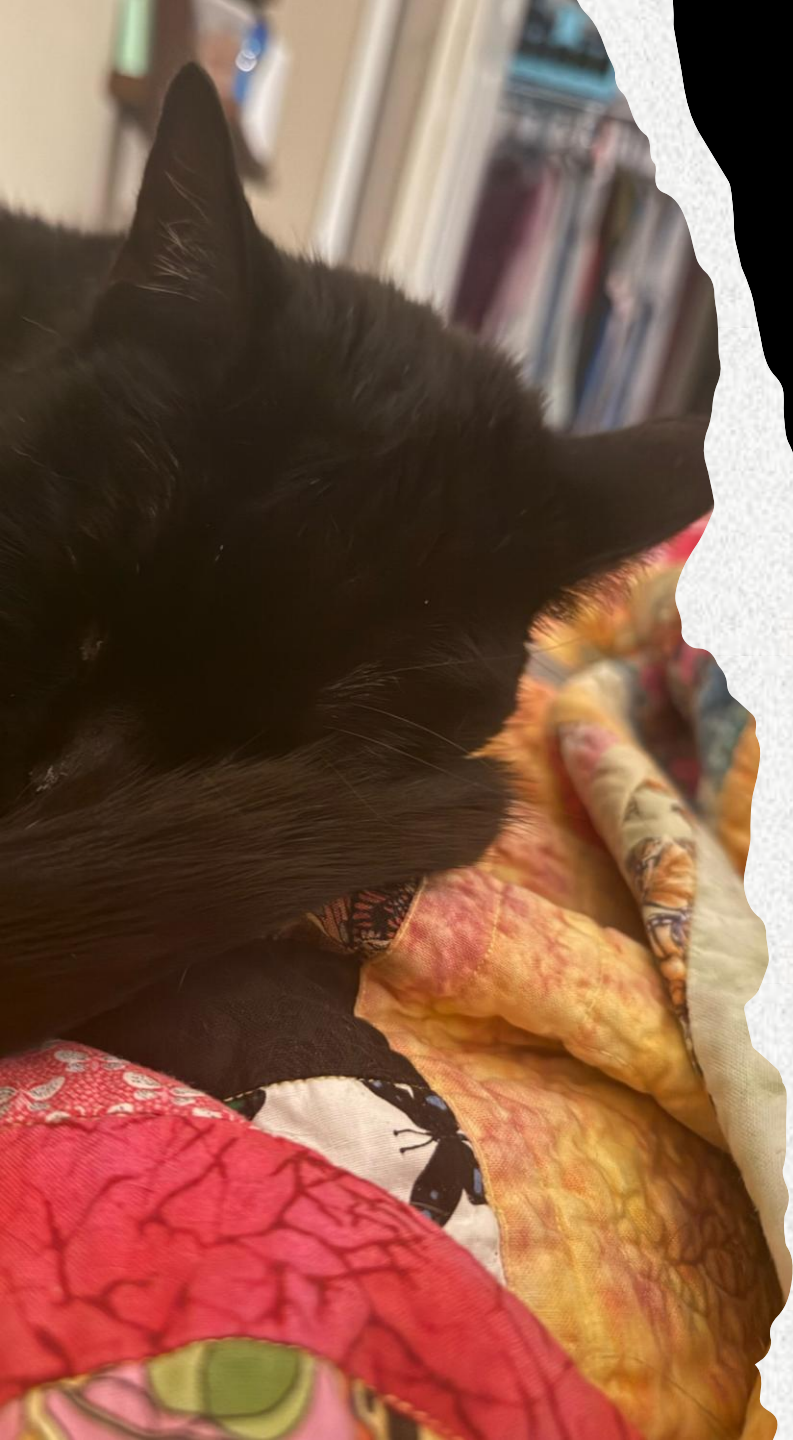




Reinforcing the Untrainable: An Applied Behavioral Analysis of Domestic Cat Training Using Positive Reinforcement Methods

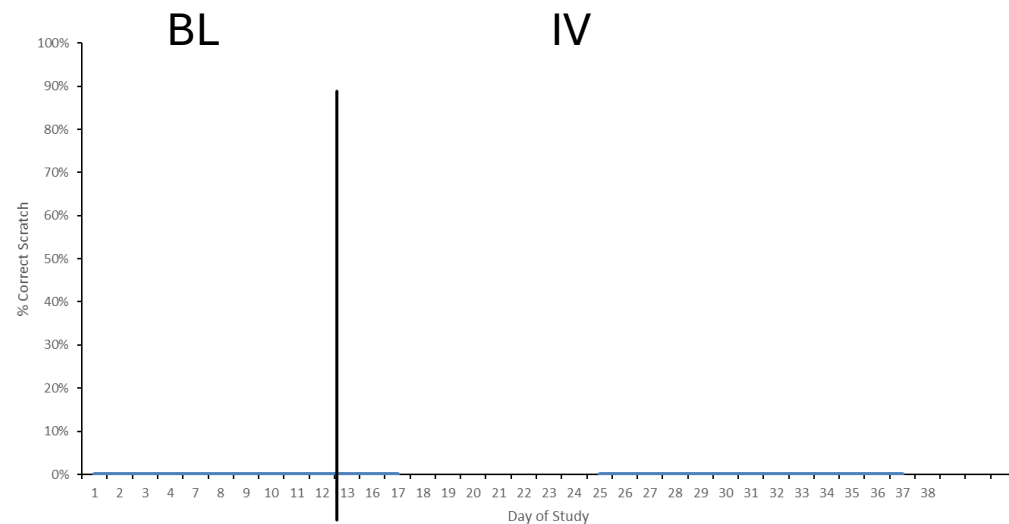
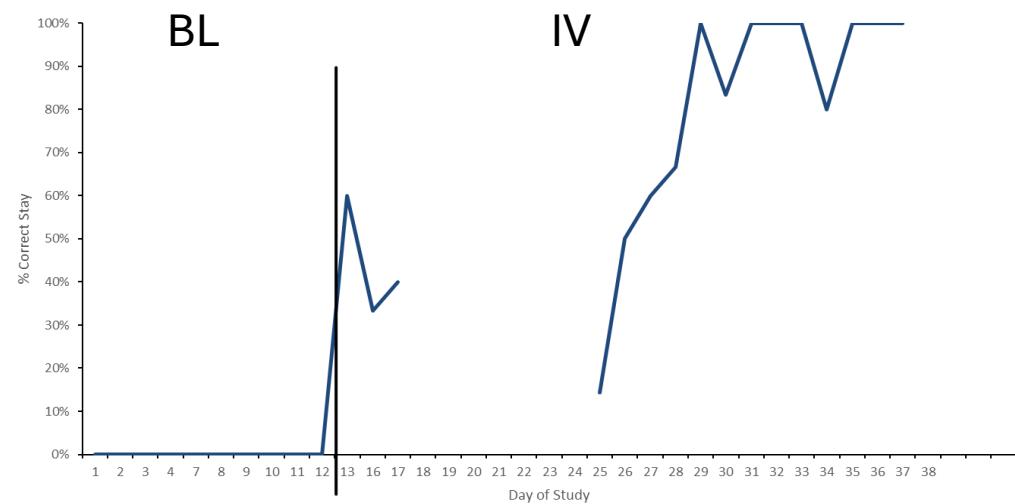
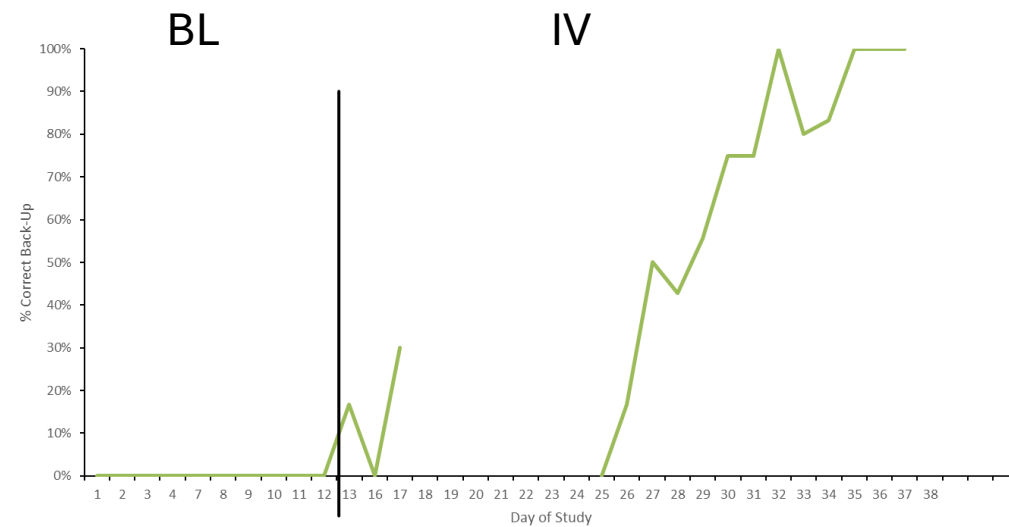
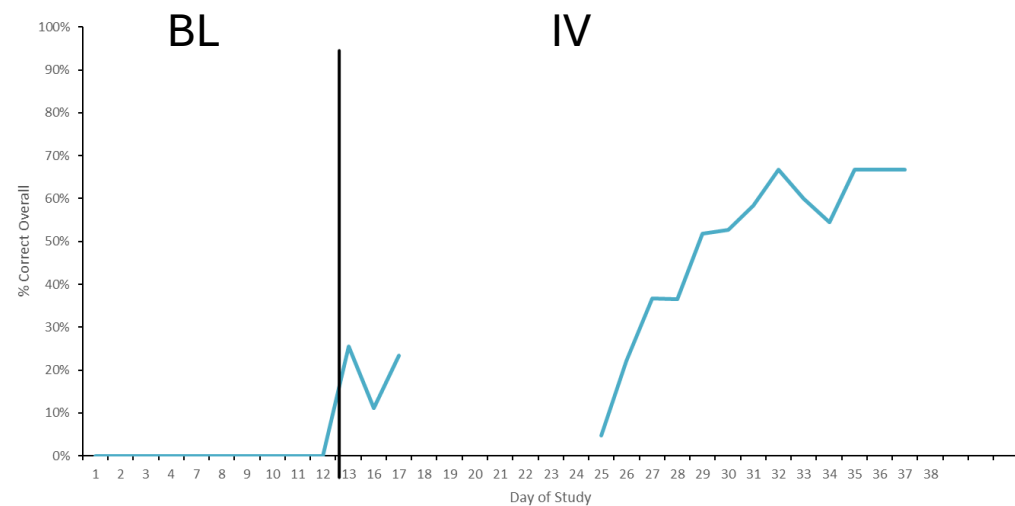
Katrina Papierman



Research Question & Intervention

- Does this ABA-oriented intervention (cat training using positive reinforcement) increase this behavior (cat tricks)?
- Measured frequency (%) correct
 - Stay: remaining in one spot
 - Back-Up : moving backwards
 - Scratch: scratching the approved surfaces
- If the cat correctly completed the behavior, I used a clicker and provided treats after a random number of cues

Graphs





Takeaways

- Research
 - Operational definitions matter a ton → may need to edit later
 - SUPER specific
 - **Real research data is not always pretty, consistent, or expected**
 - Need to consider ethics in every part of research
- Applied Behavioral Analysis
 - **Sometimes animals may not want to complete certain behaviors**
 - Reinforcement schedules can be impactful
- Writing
 - Writing long and detailed papers requires good organization and planning
 - **Keep detailed notes on revisions and reviews**
 - Long-term projects need specific goals and timelines for time management

